

The Volunteer Nurture Kit

Four ready-to-use templates · Turn one-time helpers into returning volunteers · No account required

How to use this kit: These four templates work together as a follow-up sequence. Use Template 1 within 24 hours of every event. Use Templates 2 and 3 for your highest-impact volunteers. Use Template 4 for anyone who hasn't returned in 60+ days. Personalize the bracketed fields before sending.

1 Post-Event Thank-You Email

WHEN TO SEND: Within 24 hours of the event — the window matters most

Subject: Thank you for showing up, [Name]

Hi [Name],

We just wrapped up [Event Name] and we wanted to reach out personally to say thank you.

Your [hours / contribution] made a real difference — [specific impact]. That's not a small thing.

We'd love to have you back at [Next Event / Month]. If that works, just let us know — or keep an eye out for our next invite.

With gratitude,

[Your name]

[Organization Name]

Tip: Name the specific thing they did. 'You helped 47 families get food today' lands harder than 'great job.'

2 Card-in-the-Mail Script

WHEN TO SEND: Within 1 week · Best for first-timers and standout volunteers

For first-timers:

"[Name] — we were so glad you came out. What you did for [cause / project] mattered. Hope to see you again soon. — [Organization Name]"

For returning volunteers:

"[Name] — you keep showing up, and it means everything to this organization and to the community. Thank you. — [Organization Name]"

For youth volunteers:

"[Name] — watching you serve with such energy and purpose is exactly what this organization is about. Thank you. — [Organization Name]"

Tip: A handwritten card takes 3 minutes and is kept for years. It is the highest-ROI follow-up in this kit.

3 30-Second Phone Call Guide

WHEN TO USE: Within 48 hours · For your top 3–5 volunteers per event

Open: "Hi [Name], it's [Your Name] from [Organization Name]. I just wanted to personally thank you for coming out to [Event]."

Middle: "The [specific thing they did] — we really felt it. It made a difference."

Close: "We'd love to have you back. We've got [Next Event] coming up — no pressure at all, but I'd love to send you the details if you're interested."

If they say yes: "Perfect — I'll send you the details by [day]. Thanks again, [Name]."

Tip: Keep it under 60 seconds. The goal is to make them feel seen — not to sell them on the next event.

4 Re-Invite Email for Lapsed Volunteers

WHEN TO SEND: 60+ days since last event · No guilt, no pressure

Subject: We haven't forgotten about you

Hi [Name],

It's been a while since [Event Name] — we hope you're well.

We're hosting [Upcoming Event] on [Date] and thought of you. No pressure, no awkwardness — just a genuine invitation.

If you'd like to join us, reply to this email or click here: [Link]

Either way, thank you again for what you did earlier this year. It stuck with us.

[Your name]

[Organization Name]

Tip: Send this once. If they don't respond, move on. The goal is to re-open the door — not knock it down.

TEMPLATE	SEND WITHIN	BEST FOR
1 — Thank-You Email	24 hours	All volunteers
2 — Card in the Mail	1 week	First-timers + standouts
3 — Phone Call	48 hours	Top 3–5 per event
4 — Re-Invite Email	60+ days lapsed	Anyone who hasn't returned